

tage of the free admission days. Take lots of pictures and have them playing in a digital desk frame during your next investor meeting. Travel experiences provide a common ground for discussion. And if Mr. Big Shot can only manage to make it to London once or twice a season for a weekend at a time, and you spend every winter there and can recommend some great little café next to a fabulous museum, who do you think he's going to call the next time he's in town?

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7. Celebrate the power of basic black

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Whether it's the right dress or suit, or a fresh coat of touch-up paint on that pile of thrift store frames, black is classic, oh-so-Euro, and one of the most inexpensive paint treatments out there. Got a couple of freebie floor lamps that have seen way better days? Spray them with a coat of primer and add either matte or textured black spray paint. Then shop for some stylish discount shades and you've got a remake on the cheap.

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8. Com is king

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This is literally our family motto, and has served both of us well professionally. You need to be able to

have communication with contacts regardless of any temporary set of circumstances. You can solve your own problems more quickly and nobody will really know how much you've been thrown for a loop if you still have communications established. Being out of the loop for too long is a huge professional risk. So is changing your phone number and email too often. Even if you are transitioning to the role of stay-at-home parent, you can still keep up with business contacts and start an online gig or two to keep in the game.

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9. Coffee versus drinks

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If dishing out a bar bill of several hundred dollars to court a client isn't in your budget, consider treating them to coffee at a well-known stylish establishment. Just because these shops aren't the most frugal for your daily budget doesn't mean they can't be a frugal choice when trying to climb the corporate ladder.

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10. Streamlined is sexy

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Consider some of the photo shoots from the popular design magazine, *Dwell*. They feature uncluttered, low-on-hype space. Keeping it simple allows for the most efficient use